

Word family: **instant / instantly / instantaneous / instantaneously**

Base word: instant

Related forms: instantly, instantaneous, instantaneously

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / noun (名詞) / related adverb forms (相關副詞)

Your sentence:

> “In a world where everyone seems to want **instant results**, patience feels almost like a superpower.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **instant** means **happening or being obtained immediately, with little or no waiting time**.

The speaker means people often want results **right away**, without having to wait patiently for a process to unfold.

繁體中文： **立即出現或取得、幾乎不需要等待的；即時的 / 立刻的**

中文翻譯：

> “...everyone seems to want **instant results**...”

「.....人人似乎都想要**即時 / 立刻見效的結果**.....」

Here:

instant results = 幾乎不用等待便立即出現的結果

1. **instant = immediate / happening without delay (時間) — 即時的；立即的；瞬間的**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: Happening immediately or with almost no delay.

Practice 1 — Original

> “Everyone seems to want **instant results**.”

「人人似乎都想要**即時的結果**。」

Practice 2

> “The announcement had an **instant** effect.”

「這項公告產生了**即時的**效果。」

Practice 3

> “She felt an **instant** connection with the place.”

「她立即對那個地方產生了一種**瞬間的親切 / 連結感**。」

instant = 幾乎沒有時間間隔，事情立即發生或效果立即出現的

Common:

- * instant result
- * instant effect
- * instant response
- * instant success
- * instant relief
- * instant connection

These belong to one broad **immediate/no-delay** sense.

2. **instant** = prepared/available very quickly (食品 / 服務) — 即沖的；速成的；即時可用的

Instant can describe products designed to be prepared or used very quickly.

Practice 4

> “He made a cup of **instant coffee**.”

「他沖了一杯**即溶咖啡**。」

Practice 5

> “The packet contains **instant noodles**.”

「包裝裡是**即食麵 / 即食方便麵**。」

instant + product = 經特別製作或處理，可以極快準備、沖製或使用的

Common:

- * instant coffee

* instant noodles

* instant soup

This grows directly from the “immediate” sense.

For strict core counting, I would merge it with Meaning 1 rather than treat food as an unrelated meaning.

3. **instant = immediate communication/access (科技) — 即時的**

The adjective is also extremely common in technology.

Practice 6

> “The app provides **instant** access to the information.”

「這個應用程式提供**即時**資料存取。」

Practice 7

> “They communicate through **instant messaging**.”

「他們透過**即時通訊**溝通。」

instant = 幾乎沒有等待時間，資料、訊息或服務立即可以取得 / 傳送的

Again, this is a modern domain extension of Meaning 1, not a separate core concept.

4. **an instant = a very short moment (名詞) — 一瞬間；片刻**

As a noun, **instant** means an extremely short period of time.

Practice 8

> “For an **instant**, nobody spoke.”

「有**一瞬間**，沒有人說話。」

Practice 9

> “She paused for an **instant** before answering.”

「她回答前停頓了**片刻**。」

****an instant = 極短的一段時間；一瞬間****

This is a genuinely distinct noun meaning.

5. ****the instant + clause = as soon as (連接時間) — 一.....就.....****

****The instant**** can introduce something that happened immediately when another event occurred.

Practice 10

> “The ****instant**** I saw him, I recognized him.”

「我****一看到****他，就認出他了。」

Practice 11

> “Call me the ****instant**** you arrive.”

「你****一到達就****打電話給我。」

****the instant + clause = 某件事一發生，另一件事立即發生；一.....就.....****

This develops from the noun “moment” sense.

For core counting, I would keep it under Meaning 4 as an important grammatical construction.

Related form: ****instantly****

****Instantly**** means immediately.

Practice 12

> “She recognized the song ****instantly****.”

「她****立即****認出了那首歌。」

Practice 13

> “The room became ****instantly**** quieter.”

「房間**立刻**安靜了很多。」

****instantly** = 沒有明顯延遲地；立即、馬上

Related form: ****instantaneous****

****Instantaneous**** means happening virtually at once, often with a slightly more formal or technical tone.

Practice 14

> “The reaction was almost ****instantaneous****.”

「反應幾乎是****瞬間發生的****。」

Practice 15

> “Digital communication can seem ****instantaneous****.”

「數碼通訊可以令人感覺幾乎是****瞬時的****。」

****instantaneous** = 幾乎在同一瞬間發生的；瞬時的

This is more formal than ****instant****.

Related form: ****instantaneously****

Practice 16

> “The signal is transmitted almost ****instantaneously****.”

「訊號幾乎是****瞬間傳送****的。」

****instantaneously** = 幾乎在同一瞬間、沒有可察覺延遲地

This is mostly formal/technical.

Important distinction: ****instant vs immediate****

These overlap strongly.

instant

often emphasizes:

> virtually no waiting time

immediate

means:

> happening without delay or directly following something

Compare:

> instant response

> immediate response

Both work.

But **instant** is especially common in:

* instant coffee

* instant messaging

* instant results

where **immediate** may sound less natural.

Important distinction: **instant** vs **quick**

quick

means taking a short amount of time.

instant

means happening essentially at once.

> “a quick repair”

= 修得很快，但仍需一段時間。

> “an instant result”

= 幾乎立即就有結果。

So **instant** is stronger than **quick**.

Important distinction: **instant** vs **sudden**

instant

focuses on **lack of delay**.

sudden

focuses on **unexpectedness or abruptness**.

> instant reply

= 回覆非常快。

> sudden noise

= 聲音突然出現。

Something can be instant without being surprising.

Important distinction: **instant** vs **instantaneous**

instant

is ordinary everyday English:

> instant result

> instant coffee

instantaneous

is more formal/technical and emphasizes that something occurs virtually at one moment:

> instantaneous reaction

You would not normally say:

> instantaneous coffee ❌

So the related forms are not interchangeable in every collocation.

Important distinction: **instant** vs **moment**

an instant

= an extremely short period of time

a moment

= a short period, but not necessarily as brief

> “Wait a moment.”

very natural.

> “Wait an instant.”

possible, but more marked/formal.

So **instant** strongly emphasizes brevity.

Useful expression: **in an instant** — 轉瞬間；立即

Practice 17

> “Everything changed **in an instant**.”

「一切在**一瞬間**改變了。」

Practice 18

> “The lights went out **in an instant**.”

「燈在**一瞬間**全熄了。」

in an instant = 在極短時間內；一下子

Useful expression: **this instant** — 立即；馬上

This is emphatic.

Practice 19

> “Come here **this instant!**”

「**現在馬上過來！**」

Practice 20

> “Stop that **this instant**.”

「**立刻停下來。**」

this instant = 現在立即；通常帶命令或強烈語氣

Useful construction: **instant success** — 一夜 / 立即成名或成功

Practice 21

> “The book became an **instant success**.”

「這本書一推出便**立即大受成功 / 迅速走紅**。」

Practice 22

> “The new product was an **instant hit**.”

「新產品一推出便**立即大受歡迎**。」

This belongs to the immediate-result sense.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **instant**

* **instantly**

* **instantaneous**

* **instantaneously**

Useful constructions and compounds include:

- * instant result
- * instant response
- * instant coffee
- * instant messaging
- * instant access
- * an instant
- * in an instant
- * this instant
- * the instant that...

The morphological family is fairly small, so the main learning value lies in the contrast between the adjective **instant** meaning and the noun **instant** meaning.

The Golden Manual says small families should remain small rather than being padded artificially, while common grammatical constructions and domain extensions should still be covered.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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instant — immediate	幾乎沒有等待時間，事情、結果或效果立即出現的
instant — quick-preparation product	經處理後可以非常快速準備、沖製或使用的；屬於 immediate 義
instant — technology	幾乎沒有延遲、可以立即傳送或取得的；屬於 immediate 義
an instant — noun	極短的一段時間；一瞬間 / 片刻
the instant + clause	某件事一發生，另一件事立即發生；一.....就.....
instantly	立即、馬上、沒有明顯延遲地
instantaneous	幾乎在同一瞬間發生的；較正式 / 技術性

For your original sentence

> “In a world where everyone seems to want **instant results**, patience feels almost like a superpower.”

The exact meaning is:

instant = 幾乎不用等待便立即產生或取得的

So:

> **instant results**

= 立即見效的結果 / 馬上得到的成果

The contrast is central to the whole passage:

> **instant results** = 想立刻看到成果

> **patience** = 願意讓正確的過程花時間完成

For your database, I would count **2 genuinely useful core meanings** for **instant**:

1. **adjective — immediate / happening with virtually no delay**
2. **noun — an extremely short moment**

I would merge **instant coffee / instant messaging / instant success / instant results** under #1, and keep **in an instant, this instant, the instant + clause** under #2 as important constructions rather than inflate the core count.